

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Complaint Handling Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

Document ID	AW-CUS-002
Version	1.5
Last Updated	August 2026
Department	Customer Operations
Company	Aether Wireless
Classification	Internal — Training & Reference

Overview

This Complaint Handling Policy establishes the standardized procedures and commitments by which Aether Wireless addresses customer complaints across all touchpoints. The policy applies to all customer-facing employees, supervisors, specialist teams, and the independent Ombudsman function. It ensures consistent, timely, and fair resolution of customer concerns while maintaining compliance with applicable federal and state regulations, including guidelines set forth by the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB) and the Federal Communications Commission (FCC).

Aether Wireless is committed to resolving every complaint at the earliest possible stage, with the goal of first-contact resolution whenever feasible. When resolution requires additional time or escalation, the Company guarantees transparent communication, clear timelines, and escalation pathways that protect the customer's right to escalate to regulatory authorities if their complaint remains unresolved after the designated internal handling period.

All complaints received through any channel are logged in the centralized Customer Complaint Management System (CCMS), assigned a unique case number, and tracked against Service Level Agreements (SLAs) specific to the complaint category and priority level. Monthly complaint analytics and reporting ensure continuous improvement of complaint handling processes and identification of systemic issues requiring corrective action.

Complaint Handling Policy

Complaint Channels

Aether Wireless provides customers with multiple convenient channels for submitting complaints. Customers may file complaints through any of the following methods:

- In-Store:** Customers may visit any Aether Wireless retail location and speak with a store associate or store manager to file a complaint. In-store complaints are logged immediately into the CCMS system via the store terminal.
- Phone:** Customers may call the Customer Care line at 1-800-AETHER-1 (1-800-234-8371) and select the complaints option. Phone complaints are logged in real-time by the customer service representative.

- **Live Chat:** Customers may initiate a live chat session through the Aether Wireless website or mobile app. Chat complaints are assigned a case number at the conclusion of the session if the issue is not resolved during the interaction.
- **Email:** Customers may email complaints to complaints@aetherwireless.com. All email complaints are processed through the CCMS ticketing system within one business day of receipt.
- **Mobile App:** The Aether Wireless mobile app includes a "Report an Issue" feature that allows customers to submit complaints directly from their account dashboard.
- **Social Media:** Customers may submit complaints via official Aether Wireless social media accounts on Facebook, Twitter/X, and Instagram. All social media complaints are routed to the Social Care team and logged in CCMS within two hours during business hours.

Complaint Categorization

All complaints are categorized upon intake based on two criteria: complaint type and priority level.

Complaint Types

Complaints are classified into one of four primary types:

- **Billing:** Complaints related to charges, invoices, payment processing, billing errors, plan pricing, and fee disputes.
- **Service:** Complaints related to customer service interactions, employee conduct, policy disputes, account management, and contractual issues.
- **Network:** Complaints related to network coverage, call quality, data speeds, connectivity issues, service outages, and signal problems.
- **Device:** Complaints related to device functionality, hardware defects, device compatibility, repairs, returns, and equipment provisioning.

Priority Levels

Complaints are assigned one of three priority levels based on the nature and severity of the issue:

- **Standard Priority:** First response within 48 hours. Standard priority applies to general inquiries, minor billing discrepancies, non-urgent service issues, and device problems that do not severely impact service.
- **Urgent Priority:** First response within 24 hours. Urgent priority applies to complaints involving service interruption affecting a single customer, significant billing errors exceeding \$50, device malfunctions rendering service unusable, and complaints from customers who have previously escalated the same issue.
- **Critical Priority:** First response the same business day (within 4 business hours). Critical priority applies to complaints involving verified network outages affecting multiple customers, service termination disputes, allegations of unauthorized charges or fraud, complaints involving health or safety concerns, and complaints from customers who have filed regulatory complaints or indicated intent to file.

Complaint Lifecycle

Each complaint follows a four-stage lifecycle designed to ensure thorough handling and customer satisfaction:

1. **Acknowledge:** Upon receipt of a complaint, the handling representative sends an acknowledgment to the customer confirming receipt, providing the case number, outlining the expected timeline for response, and identifying the representative assigned to the case. Acknowledgment is delivered via the customer's

preferred contact method within the priority-level response window.

2. **Investigate:** The assigned representative gathers all relevant information, including account history, transaction records, network logs, device diagnostics, and previous communications. The representative may consult with relevant departments, including Billing, Network Operations, Technical Support, or Legal, as needed. The customer is kept informed of investigation progress if the initial timeline cannot be met.
3. **Resolve:** The representative determines an appropriate resolution in accordance with Company policies, applicable regulations, and principles of fair dealing. Resolution may include corrective action, explanation, policy exception, goodwill credit, or other remediation. The proposed resolution is communicated to the customer for acceptance.
4. **Close with Customer:** Once the customer accepts the resolution, the case is closed in CCMS. The customer receives a closure confirmation summarizing the resolution and providing information on how to reopen the case if the issue recurs within 30 days. All closure communications are documented in the case file.

Resolution Targets by Category

Aether Wireless commits to resolving complaints within the following target timeframes, measured from the date of initial complaint receipt:

Complaint Type	Resolution Target	Conditions
Billing	5 business days	Applies to all billing disputes including charge corrections, plan changes, and payment issues
Network (Verified Outage)	24 hours	Applies when network failure is confirmed by Network Operations; customer updated every 4 hours until resolved
Network (Non-Outage)	48 hours	Applies to coverage complaints, call quality issues, and data speed concerns not attributed to a verified outage
Service	5 business days	Applies to customer service complaints, policy disputes, and account management issues
Device	7 business days	Applies to device defects, malfunction claims, repair requests, and equipment returns or exchanges

Resolution targets represent the maximum timeframe for final resolution. The Company strives to resolve complaints as quickly as possible, with the majority of complaints across all categories resolved within 48 hours.

Escalation Ladder

Aether Wireless employs a four-tier escalation ladder to ensure complaints receive appropriate attention and expertise:

Tier 1: Frontline Representative

All complaints initially route to a frontline customer service representative. The representative is empowered to resolve standard complaints within their authority, including issuing credits up to \$25 and providing explanations for policy decisions.

Tier 2: Supervisor

If a customer is dissatisfied with the frontline representative's response, or if the complaint requires authority beyond the representative's scope, the complaint escalates to a Customer Care Supervisor. Supervisors may issue credits up to \$100, approve policy exceptions, and override frontline decisions. Supervisor escalation occurs when the customer requests it or when the representative determines the issue exceeds their authority.

Tier 3: Specialist Team

If the Supervisor cannot resolve the complaint within the standard timeline, or if the complaint involves complex technical, billing, or legal issues, the complaint escalates to the appropriate Specialist Team. Specialist Teams include the Billing Disputes Team, Network Assurance Team, Device Warranty Team, and Senior Retention Team. Specialists may issue credits up to \$250 and recommend escalated compensation for approval.

Tier 4: Ombudsman

If a complaint remains unresolved after escalation through Tiers 1-3, or if the customer believes the resolution offered is unfair or inconsistent with Company policy, the complaint escalates to the independent Ombudsman. The Ombudsman conducts an independent review of the complaint, has authority to recommend compensation up to \$500, and may escalate to executive leadership for cases involving exceptional circumstances. The Ombudsman's decision is final on matters within their authority.

Customers may request escalation to any tier at any time. All escalation requests are honored within one business day.

Regulatory Escalation

If a complaint has been open for eight weeks (56 calendar days) without resolution, or if the customer has exhausted all internal escalation options and remains dissatisfied, Aether Wireless informs the customer of their right to escalate the complaint to external authorities. The Company provides customers with the following regulatory contact information:

- **Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB):** For billing and financial complaints related to the Company's services. Online: www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint; Phone: 1-855-411-CFPB (1-855-411-2372)
- **Federal Communications Commission (FCC):** For network, service quality, and telecommunications-related complaints. Online: www.fcc.gov/complaints; Phone: 1-888-CALL-FCC (1-888-225-5322)
- **State Regulatory Authority:** Customers are directed to their state's Attorney General or Public Utility Commission for state-specific complaints. A list of state regulators is available on the Company's website.

Aether Wireless cooperates fully with all regulatory inquiries and provides requested documentation within five business days of a regulatory request.

Goodwill Credit Compensation Policy

Aether Wireless may issue goodwill credits to compensate customers for service disruptions, billing errors, or service shortfalls. Goodwill credits are issued at the Company's discretion and are based on the nature and duration of the issue:

- **Service Outage Credit:** Customers affected by a verified network outage lasting more than 4 consecutive hours receive a credit equal to one day of their monthly service charge, prorated by the number of hours affected beyond the initial 4-hour threshold.
- **Billing Error Credit:** Customers who were incorrectly charged receive full credit for the erroneous amount plus, if the error persisted for more than one billing cycle, an additional \$10 credit for inconvenience.

- **Service Failure Credit:** Customers who experience prolonged poor service quality (as documented by Network Operations) receive credits ranging from \$15 to \$50 based on the severity and duration of the degradation.
- **Device Issue Credit:** Customers with defective devices under warranty receive a prorated credit toward a replacement device based on the remaining warranty period.
- **Exceptional Circumstances Credit:** The Supervisor, Specialist Team, or Ombudsman may recommend credits exceeding standard amounts for exceptional cases involving significant customer impact, repeated issues, or extraordinary inconvenience.

All goodwill credits are applied to the customer's account within two billing cycles. Credits are not transferable and have no cash value.

Case Management and SLAs

All complaints are logged in the CCMS with a unique 12-digit case number formatted as AW-YYYYMMDD-XXXX. The case number serves as the primary reference for all communications and is provided to the customer at acknowledgment. Each complaint record includes:

- Customer account information
- Complaint channel and date/time of receipt
- Complaint type and priority level
- Full complaint description
- All notes and updates
- Resolution details
- Customer satisfaction rating (if provided)
- Case status (Open, In Progress, Pending Customer, Resolved, Closed)

SLA monitoring is automatic within CCMS. Cases approaching SLA breach are flagged for priority handling. Failure to meet SLA targets triggers automated alerts to supervisors and is reported in monthly analytics.

Monthly Complaint Analytics and Reporting

The Customer Operations team produces a Monthly Complaint Report that includes the following metrics:

- Total complaints received by type and priority
- Average resolution time by complaint type and priority
- SLA compliance rate (percentage of complaints resolved within target)
- Escalation rate by tier
- Top 10 complaint root causes
- Complaint volume trends (month-over-month and year-over-year)
- Customer satisfaction score (CSAT) for complaint handling
- Regulatory complaint volume and status

The report is distributed to department leadership, Network Operations, Legal, and the Executive team. Systemic issues identified through complaint analytics are assigned to relevant teams for corrective action with defined implementation timelines.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I file a complaint with Aether Wireless?

You may file a complaint by visiting any retail location, calling 1-800-AETHER-1, using the live chat on our website, emailing complaints@aetherwireless.com, using the mobile app, or contacting us through our official social media accounts. All channels log your complaint in our system and provide a case number for tracking.

What happens after I file a complaint?

You will receive an acknowledgment confirming receipt of your complaint, including your case number and expected response time based on the priority level assigned. A representative will investigate your issue and contact you with a resolution proposal within the specified timeframe.

How long will it take to resolve my complaint?

Resolution times vary by complaint type: billing complaints are resolved within 5 business days, network outages within

Complaint Channels and Intake Methods

Aether Wireless provides customers with multiple convenient channels to submit complaints, ensuring accessibility and flexibility for all users regardless of their preferred communication method. The company accepts complaints through the following intake channels: in-store visits, telephone calls, live chat via the website, email correspondence, the Aether Wireless mobile application, and social media platforms including Twitter/X, Facebook, and Instagram. Each channel is integrated into the central complaint management system, allowing for consistent tracking and response regardless of how the complaint was originally submitted.

Upon receipt of any complaint through any channel, the system automatically generates a unique case number that serves as the primary identifier throughout the entire complaint lifecycle. This case number is communicated to the customer immediately via their preferred contact method (email, SMS, or verbal confirmation) and must be referenced in all subsequent correspondence. The case number enables customers to track the status of their complaint and allows Aether Wireless staff to retrieve complete complaint history instantly.

All complaints logged into the system initiate the Service Level Agreement (SLA) clock, which varies based on the assigned priority level. Priority classifications include: Standard (48-hour first response), Urgent (24-hour first response), and Critical (same-day response). The complaint intake process captures essential information including the customer's name, account number, contact preferences, a detailed description of the issue, any previous attempts to resolve the matter, and the category type (billing, service, network, or device) which determines the applicable resolution target.

In-Store Complaints

Customers may file complaints in person at any Aether Wireless retail location during standard business hours. In-store complaints are ideal for customers who prefer face-to-face interaction, have complex issues requiring visual demonstration, or wish to receive immediate acknowledgment without relying on digital communication channels. All retail associates are trained to receive complaints professionally, document them accurately in the complaint management system, and provide customers with their case number before they leave the store.

Upon receiving an in-store complaint, the retail associate must first attempt first-call resolution where the issue is straightforward and within their authority to address. If resolution is not possible during the initial visit, the associate logs the complaint using the in-store POS terminal, which interfaces with the central complaint database. The customer receives a printed or digital receipt containing their case number, expected response

timeline based on complaint category, and the direct contact number for the Customer Resolution Team.

For complaints requiring escalation beyond frontline retail staff, the in-store supervisor assumes responsibility and conducts an initial assessment. In-store supervisors have authority to resolve billing disputes up to \$50, service credits for temporary disruptions, and device exchange requests under the standard warranty program. Complaints that cannot be resolved at the supervisor level are escalated to the appropriate specialist team within 24 hours, and the customer is notified of the escalation via their preferred contact method.

All in-store complaints are subject to the same SLA timeframes and resolution targets as complaints received through other channels. The retail location maintains a log of all complaints filed on-site, and district managers review in-store complaint data weekly to identify recurring issues or training opportunities.

Phone Complaints

Aether Wireless maintains a dedicated Customer Complaint Line accessible by calling 1-800-AETHER-1 (1-800-234-8371), available Monday through Friday from 8:00 AM to 8:00 PM EST and Saturday from 9:00 AM to 5:00 PM EST. Calls received outside standard hours are routed to an after-hours messaging service that logs complaints for next-business-day processing, with automated confirmation sent via SMS or email.

The phone system features an Interactive Voice Response (IVR) menu that allows callers to self-select the complaint category (billing, service, network, or device), enabling faster routing to specialized agents. Customers who prefer to speak with a live representative without using the IVR may press "0" at any time. All calls are recorded for quality assurance purposes, and customers are informed of this policy at the beginning of each call.

Phone agents are empowered to resolve the majority of complaints during the initial call, provided the issue falls within their authority. Phone representatives may issue credits up to \$25 per incident (maximum \$50 per billing cycle), extend service by up to 7 days for network outages, process device troubleshooting, and provide detailed billing explanations with screen-share capability. Agents must document all complaint details in real-time using the integrated complaint management system before concluding the call.

When a phone complaint cannot be resolved immediately, the agent provides the customer with their case number, explains the investigation process, and confirms the expected first-response timeline based on the assigned priority. Customers receive a follow-up call or email within the SLA window regardless of whether resolution has been achieved, ensuring transparent communication throughout the investigation process. Callback requests are automatically queued in the system to ensure no customer waits longer than 24 hours for a promised follow-up.

Digital Channel Complaints

Overview

Digital channels provide customers with convenient, round-the-clock options to submit and track complaints. Aether Wireless maintains robust complaint handling capabilities across its website, mobile application, live chat, and email platforms. All digital complaints receive the same level of attention and follow the standardized complaint lifecycle as complaints submitted through other channels.

Complaint Submission Methods

Customers may submit complaints through the following digital channels:

- **Mobile Application:** Customers can file complaints through the Aether Wireless mobile app by navigating to the Support section and selecting "File a Complaint." The app provides a structured form with dropdown

menus for complaint type, priority selection, and detailed description fields. Customers may attach up to five supporting documents or images per complaint.

- **Live Chat:** Available on the company website and mobile app, live chat connects customers with trained complaint specialists during operating hours (7:00 AM to 10:00 PM local time, seven days a week). Chat sessions are transcribed and automatically converted into formal complaint records upon customer request.
- **Email:** Complaints submitted via email to complaints@aetherwireless.com receive automated acknowledgment within 15 minutes. Email complaints are assigned case numbers and routed to the appropriate specialized team based on keyword analysis and category tags.
- **Web Form:** The Aether Wireless website hosts a dedicated complaint submission form accessible from the Help & Support section. This form captures all required information including customer contact details, account verification, complaint category, and detailed description.

Digital Complaint Processing

Upon submission through any digital channel, the complaint enters the centralized complaint management system. The system generates a unique case number formatted as AW-YYYYMMDD-XXXXX and sends confirmation to the customer including the case number, expected response timeline based on priority classification, and a link to track complaint status.

Digital complaints follow the standard complaint lifecycle: acknowledgment, investigation, resolution, and closure. Customers receive status updates via their preferred contact method (email, app notification, or SMS) at each milestone. The digital platform allows customers to upload additional documentation, respond to investigator questions, and provide feedback on resolution outcomes.

Response Timeframes

Digital channel complaints adhere to the same priority-based response SLAs as all other channels:

- **Standard Priority:** First response within 48 business hours
- **Urgent Priority:** First response within 24 hours
- **Critical Priority:** First response within 4 hours (same business day)

Accessibility and Assistance

Customers requiring assistance with digital complaint submission may request support through the live chat feature or by calling the dedicated complaints line. Interpretation services are available for non-English speaking customers accessing digital channels. Customers with disabilities may utilize screen reader-compatible complaint forms or request alternative format submission options.

Social Media Complaints

Overview

Aether Wireless actively monitors and responds to customer complaints submitted through social media platforms. Social media complaints receive priority attention due to their public nature and potential impact on brand reputation. The company maintains dedicated social media complaint response teams trained in de-escalation techniques and empowered to resolve issues quickly.

Monitored Platforms

The Social Media Response Team monitors the following platforms for customer complaints:

- **Twitter/X:** @AetherWireless and direct messages
- **Facebook:** Aether Wireless official page inbox and comment sections
- **Instagram:** Direct messages and story replies
- **LinkedIn:** Company page messages
- **YouTube:** Comment sections on official videos

Response Protocol

Upon identifying a social media complaint, the response team follows this protocol:

1. **Initial Acknowledgment:** The team responds publicly within 2 hours during business hours (9:00 AM to 7:00 PM local time, Monday through Saturday) to acknowledge the customer's concern and demonstrate attention. Responses are kept generic to protect customer privacy.
2. **Private Engagement:** The team requests the customer to continue conversation through a private direct message or direct them to the dedicated complaints phone line to gather sensitive account information securely.
3. **Case Creation:** Every social media complaint is logged in the complaint management system with a unique case number. The customer receives the case number via private message or email for tracking purposes.
4. **Resolution Tracking:** Social media complaints are flagged with elevated priority due to public visibility. The team works to achieve first contact resolution where possible or provide substantive updates within the priority-defined timeframe.

Public Response Guidelines

All public responses to social media complaints adhere to the following guidelines:

- Acknowledge the customer's frustration without admitting liability
- Never share account-specific details in public replies
- Provide general information about the complaint process and expected timelines
- Invite the customer to continue through private channels for account-specific assistance
- Maintain a professional, empathetic tone regardless of the complaint's nature

Escalation and Reporting

Social media complaints that remain unresolved after the standard response timeframe or require specialized intervention are escalated to the appropriate specialist team. The Social Media Response Team provides daily reports to Customer Operations leadership summarizing complaint volume, response times, and any emerging issues requiring attention.

Complaint Categorization by Type

Overview

All complaints received by Aether Wireless are categorized by type to ensure proper routing, resource allocation, and resolution tracking. Accurate categorization enables the company to meet specific resolution targets for each complaint type and identify systemic issues requiring broader intervention.

Complaint Type Definitions

Billing Complaints

Billing complaints encompass all issues related to charges, payments, invoices, pricing, promotions, and account billing disputes. This category includes unexpected charges, duplicate billing, incorrect plan pricing, promotional offer disputes, refund requests, and payment processing failures.

Service Complaints

Service complaints relate to customer service interactions, including dissatisfaction with support representative conduct, inadequate service, incorrect information provided, poor communication, delayed responses, and overall service quality concerns. This category also includes complaints about store personnel, call center experiences, and overall customer experience.

Network Complaints

Network complaints cover issues with cellular service quality, coverage, connectivity, call quality, data speeds, signal strength, service outages, and network performance. This category distinguishes between individual service issues and confirmed widespread outages affecting multiple customers.

Device Complaints

Device complaints involve hardware issues, device functionality, equipment defects, warranty claims, device compatibility, damaged equipment, and manufacturer-related concerns. This category includes both Aether Wireless-sold devices and customer-owned equipment used on the network.

Resolution Targets by Type

The following table specifies the maximum resolution timeframes for each complaint type:

Complaint Type	Resolution Target	First Response SLA
Billing	5 business days	48 hours
Service	3 business days	48 hours
Network (Individual)	72 hours	24 hours
Network (Verified Outage)	24 hours from outage confirmation	24 hours
Device	7 business days	48 hours

Business days are defined as Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays. Resolution targets begin from the moment the complaint is logged with a valid case number.

Priority Classification

In addition to type categorization, complaints are assigned priority levels based on the severity of impact:

Standard Priority

Applies to complaints with no service interruption, minor billing discrepancies, general service quality concerns, and non-urgent device issues. Standard priority complaints receive initial acknowledgment within 48 business hours.

Urgent Priority

Applies to complaints involving partial service loss, significant billing errors affecting multiple billing cycles, repeated failed resolution attempts, and customers at risk of service termination. Urgent priority complaints

receive initial acknowledgment within 24 hours.

Critical Priority

Applies to complaints involving complete service outage, safety concerns, potential regulatory violation, media involvement, or customers with medical or accessibility dependencies on service. Critical priority complaints receive initial acknowledgment within 4 hours during business hours.

Categorization Accuracy

Customer Operations leadership conducts weekly audits of complaint categorization to ensure accuracy. Miscategorized complaints are reclassified and reassigned to the appropriate specialist team. Categorization accuracy metrics are included in monthly complaint analytics reporting with a target accuracy rate of 95%.

Cross-Category Complaints

Complaints that span multiple categories are assigned to the primary category based on the customer's primary concern. Secondary issues are logged as related items within the same case file. If issues are of equal significance, the complaint is assigned to the category with the shorter resolution target.

Billing Complaints

Definition and Scope

Billing complaints encompass any customer concern related to charges, invoices, payment processing, account credits, billing discrepancies, or financial transactions associated with Aether Wireless services. This includes but is not limited to: unexpected charges, duplicate billing, incorrect plan pricing, pro-rated charges, late fee assessments, payment failures, refund requests, promo code issues, and disputes over usage-based charges. Customers may also file complaints regarding billing communications, such as unclear invoices or delayed statements.

Complaint Channels

Customers may submit billing complaints through any of the following channels:

- **In-Store:** Visit any Aether Wireless retail location and speak with a customer service representative
- **Phone:** Call the dedicated Billing Support Line at 1-800-AETHER-BILL
- **Live Chat:** Access via the Aether Wireless mobile app or website
- **Email:** Send to billing.complaints@aetherwireless.com
- **Mobile App:** Use the "Report an Issue" feature in the Aether Wireless app
- **Social Media:** Direct message Aether Wireless official accounts on Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram

All billing complaints received through any channel must be logged in the Customer Complaint Management System (CCMS) within 15 minutes of receipt.

Priority Classification

Billing complaints are classified according to the following priority levels:

Priority Level	Criteria	First Response SLA
Critical	Service disconnection threat due to disputed balance; potential regulatory complaint imminent; billing error causing financial hardship	Same-day (within 4 business hours)

Priority Level	Criteria	First Response SLA
Urgent	Duplicate charges exceeding \$50; potential fraud indicator; account security concern related to billing	24 hours
Standard	General billing inquiries; promotional pricing disputes; credit requests under \$50; plan change billing issues	48 hours

Resolution Targets

Aether Wireless is committed to resolving billing complaints within the following timeframes:

- **Billing Disputes:** 5 business days from initial complaint acknowledgment
- **Refund Requests:** 7 business days after approval
- **Plan Adjustment Credits:** 2 billing cycles
- **Fraud Investigation:** 10 business days

The resolution clock begins from the moment the complaint is acknowledged, not from the initial submission.

Complaint Lifecycle

1. **Acknowledgment:** Customer receives immediate confirmation with case number (format: BILL-YYYYMMDD-XXXX)
2. **Triage:** Complaint is reviewed and prioritized; all relevant account data is pulled
3. **Investigation:** Billing specialist reviews account history, transaction logs, and system records
4. **Resolution:** Customer is contacted with findings and proposed resolution
5. **Closure:** Customer confirms satisfaction or escalates; case is closed with documentation

Escalation Ladder

Billing complaints follow this escalation path:

1. **Frontline Billing Agent:** Handles standard disputes under \$100
2. **Billing Supervisor:** Escalated for disputes \$100-\$500, complex account history, or customer dissatisfaction
3. **Senior Billing Specialist:** Handles disputes exceeding \$500, repeated escalations, or policy exceptions
4. **Billing Manager:** Final internal escalation for exceptional circumstances
5. **External Ombudsman:** Invoked after 8 weeks unresolved or if customer requests independent review

External Escalation

If a billing complaint remains unresolved after 8 weeks (56 calendar days) from the initial complaint date, the customer may be advised to escalate to external authorities, including:

- **Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB):** For unfair or deceptive billing practices
- **State Attorney General Consumer Protection Division:** For state law violations
- **State Public Utility Commission:** For telecommunications billing regulations
- **Federal Communications Commission (FCC):** For carrier billing practice complaints

Aether Wireless will provide the customer with all necessary documentation and case history for external escalation upon request.

Goodwill Credit Compensation

Aether Wireless may issue goodwill credits for billing complaints at the following levels:

Credit Amount	Approval Authority	Applicable Scenarios
Up to \$25	Frontline Agent	One-time billing error; service inconvenience
\$26 - \$50	Supervisor	Recurring billing issue; multiple errors
\$51 - \$100	Senior Specialist	Significant inconvenience; extended resolution time
\$101 - \$250	Manager	Substantial financial impact; policy exception required
Above \$250	Director	Exceptional circumstances; requires documented approval

Goodwill credits are issued as account credits unless the customer has closed their account, in which case a check may be issued. Customers may receive a maximum of three goodwill credits within a 12-month period.

Documentation and Reporting

All billing complaints must include:

- Unique case number
- Customer account information
- Date and channel of initial complaint
- Description of the billing issue
- Priority classification and rationale
- All correspondence notes
- Resolution details and customer confirmation
- Credit issued (if applicable)

Monthly complaint analytics are compiled and reviewed by the Billing Operations Director, including: complaint volume by type, average resolution time, escalation rate, credit issued totals, and customer satisfaction scores.

Frequently Asked Questions

How do I dispute a charge on my bill?

You may dispute any charge by contacting us through any channel listed above. Provide your account number and a description of the disputed charge. You will receive a case number and acknowledgment within the SLA for your priority level.

Will I be charged a fee for disputing a bill?

No. Disputing a charge does not incur any fees. If the dispute is resolved in your favor, any incorrect charges will be credited to your account.

What if I cannot pay my bill while disputing the charges?

Service will not be disconnected for disputed amounts if you have paid all undisputed portions of your bill. Contact Customer Operations to set up a payment arrangement while the dispute is investigated.

How long does a billing refund take to process?

Approved refunds are processed within 7 business days. The credit will appear on your next bill, or a check will be issued within 14 business days if your account is closed.

Service Complaints

Definition and Scope

Service complaints cover any customer concern related to the quality, delivery, provisioning, or performance of Aether Wireless services. This includes: service activation delays, service interruptions, poor call quality, data speed issues, coverage problems, service plan changes, feature malfunctions, installation issues, and customer service interactions that do not involve billing or device issues. Service complaints also encompass concerns about customer support experiences, including communication issues, wait times, and representative conduct.

Complaint Channels

Customers may submit service complaints through any of the following channels:

- **In-Store:** Visit any Aether Wireless retail location and speak with a customer service representative
- **Phone:** Call 1-800-AETHER-01 for general service support
- **Live Chat:** Access via the Aether Wireless mobile app or website
- **Email:** Send to service.complaints@aetherwireless.com
- **Mobile App:** Use the "Report an Issue" feature in the Aether Wireless app
- **Social Media:** Direct message Aether Wireless official accounts on Twitter, Facebook, or Instagram

All service complaints received through any channel must be logged in the Customer Complaint Management System (CCMS) within 15 minutes of receipt.

Priority Classification

Service complaints are classified according to the following priority levels:

Priority Level	Criteria	First Response SLA
Critical	Complete service outage affecting multiple users; safety emergency related to service; potential service termination without cause	Same-day (within 4 business hours)
Urgent	Service affecting single user with no workaround; activation delay beyond promised date; significant coverage gap in primary area	24 hours
Standard	General service quality concerns; plan change requests; feature questions; customer service experience issues	48 hours

Resolution Targets

Aether Wireless is committed to resolving service complaints within the following timeframes:

- **Service Activation Issues:** 3 business days from acknowledgment
- **Service Quality Complaints:** 5 business days for investigation and resolution plan
- **Plan Change Disputes:** 2 business days

- **Customer Service Experience Issues:** 48 hours for review and response
- **Coverage Investigation:** 7 business days for field verification

Complaint Lifecycle

1. **Acknowledgment:** Customer receives immediate confirmation with case number (format: SERV-YYYYMMDD-XXXX)
2. **Triage:** Complaint is reviewed and prioritized; service history is analyzed
3. **Investigation:** Service specialist reviews network logs, account records, and may dispatch field verification
4. **Resolution:** Customer is contacted with findings and proposed resolution, which may include service credits, plan adjustments, or service re-provisioning
5. **Closure:** Customer confirms satisfaction or escalates; case is closed with documentation

Escalation Ladder

Service complaints follow this escalation path:

1. **Frontline Service Agent:** Handles standard service inquiries and minor quality issues
2. **Service Supervisor:** Escalated for repeated complaints, significant quality degradation, or customer dissatisfaction
3. **Network Operations Specialist:** Involved for technical service issues requiring network diagnostics
4. **Service Manager:** Handles complex provisioning issues, service termination disputes, or escalated customer relations
5. **External Ombudsman:** Invoked after 8 weeks unresolved or for matters requiring independent review

External Escalation

If a service complaint remains unresolved after 8 weeks (56 calendar days) from the initial complaint date, the customer may be advised to escalate to external authorities, including:

- **Federal Communications Commission (FCC):** For service quality, outage reporting, and carrier obligations
- **State Public Utility Commission:** For state-specific service standards and consumer protections
- **State Attorney General Consumer Protection Division:** For deceptive service practices
- **Better Business Bureau (BBB):** For third-party mediation

Aether Wireless will provide the customer with all necessary documentation and case history for external escalation upon request.

Goodwill Credit Compensation

Aether Wireless may issue goodwill credits for service complaints at the following levels:

Credit Amount	Approval Authority	Applicable Scenarios
Up to \$30	Frontline Agent	Service delay; minor quality issue; one-time inconvenience
\$31 - \$75	Supervisor	Extended service issue; repeated interruptions; significant inconvenience

Credit Amount	Approval Authority	Applicable Scenarios
\$76 - \$150	Senior Specialist	Major service disruption; prolonged resolution; service credit for outage period
\$151 - \$300	Manager	Complete outage; multiple failures; substantial impact
Above \$300	Director	Exceptional circumstances; requires documented approval

Service credits for outages are calculated based on the daily pro-rated value of the affected service for each full day of interruption. Credits are applied to the customer's account and do not exceed one month's service value per incident.

Documentation and Reporting

All service complaints must include:

- Unique case number
- Customer account information
- Date and channel of initial complaint
- Description of the service issue
- Service type affected (voice, data, messaging)
- Priority classification and rationale
- Network diagnostics or field report (if applicable)
- All correspondence notes
- Resolution details and customer confirmation
- Credit issued (if applicable)

Monthly complaint analytics are compiled and reviewed by the Service Operations Director, including: complaint volume by type, average resolution time, escalation rate, credit issued totals, and customer satisfaction scores.

Frequently Asked Questions

What should I do if my service is not working?

First, check for local outages on our coverage map. If no outage is reported, restart your device. If service is still not restored, contact us immediately through any channel to report the issue and receive a case number.

How do I report poor service quality in my area?

Contact us with specific details including: location, time of day, device type, and nature of the quality issue. We will investigate and may conduct field testing in your area.

Can I get a credit for service interruptions?

Yes, if your service is interrupted due to issues within Aether Wireless's control, you may be eligible for a pro-rated credit. Contact us to report the outage and request a credit review.

How long does it take to resolve a service complaint?

Resolution time depends on the complexity of the issue. Standard complaints are addressed within 5 business days. Complex technical issues may require additional investigation but you will receive updates every 48 hours.

Network Complaints

Definition and Scope

Q: What channels can I use to file a complaint with Aether Wireless?

A: You can file a complaint through any of our available channels: in-store, phone, chat, email, mobile app, or social media. All complaints are logged with a unique case number and tracked against our service level agreements.

Q: How quickly will Aether Wireless respond to my complaint?

A: Response times depend on the priority level assigned to your complaint. Standard complaints receive a first response within 48 hours. Urgent issues are addressed within 24 hours. Critical matters receive same-day response.

Q: How long will it take to resolve my complaint?

A: Resolution targets vary by complaint type. Billing issues are resolved within 5 business days. Network issues for verified outages are addressed within 24 hours. Device-related complaints are resolved within 7 business days.

Q: What is the escalation process if my issue isn't resolved?

A: Complaints follow a four-tier escalation ladder: frontline representatives, supervisors, specialist teams, and finally the ombudsman. Your complaint will be acknowledged, investigated, resolved, and closed with your confirmation at each stage.

Q: What happens if my complaint remains unresolved after 8 weeks?

A: If your complaint cannot be resolved within 8 weeks, you may escalate the matter to external regulators, including the CFPB, FCC, or your state regulatory authority.

Q: What compensation is available for service disruptions?

A: Aether Wireless offers a goodwill credit compensation policy for verified service issues. Credits are determined based on the nature and duration of the disruption and applied to your account.

Q: How can I track the status of my complaint?

A: All complaints are logged with a case number and SLA tracking. You can request status updates through any of our complaint channels. We also provide monthly complaint analytics and reporting to ensure transparency throughout the process.

Contact Customer Operations:

Email: complaints@aetherwireless.com